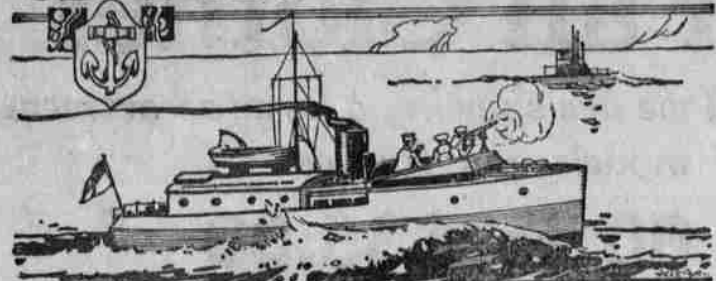


SEA SLUG STORIES



Thrilling Tales of U Boat Hunting, Told by an American Boy Who Served For Months With the British Patrol and Who Did the Thrilling and Perilous Work That is Now Being Done by Hundreds of Other American Boys.

No. 3 A Motor Launch Raid on the Belgian Coast

By
A SEA SLUG,
British Service Name For Crews
of Submarine Chasers.
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PROLOGUE.

The author of this series of four articles is a young American, who has spent most of his time since the war started with the British patrol fleet, taking an important part in helping to organize that branch of the service known as the Sea Slugs.

He has accumulated a remarkable collection of anecdotes incident to this exciting branch of the service, and many of these were personal adventures in which he took part and which make out of the war, he recently returned to the United States to assist the American navy in organizing the same branch of the service and should be of great value because of his experience abroad. So far as known, he is the only American to serve with the British patrol prior to the advent of the United States destroyer flotilla in British waters. Of course some of his experiences, of military value to the enemy, cannot be related. At the request of the service publication of his name is withheld.

It is better that I do not mention the name of the Sea Slug who conceived the idea of a motor launch raid on the coast of Belgium—that part of the coast held by Germany, bordering the English Channel.



There is No Moon. We Dash Along Full Speed Ahead.

dered by a maze of mines, skirt by a moving belt of gunboats and patrol craft and freckled with a series of land batteries which make the experts say it would be mathematically impossible to smash into the naval bases from the sea side.

The British government prefers to keep his name secret for the present, so it would not be policy for me to divulge it. When he put the idea up to the commander of the base he said right away:

"I don't want to lose more than six boats. If you can get six crews to volunteer for the service go ahead. I won't order anybody on a raid like that."

Six times six crews volunteered, but only six were allowed to go. We chug-chugged out of Dover just before sundown, every man with a lifebelt strapped under his shoulders, petrol tanks filled to the last drop, ammunition in every available space and every motor thoroughly inspected down to the last screw.

We were thinking only of what a time we were going to give the Boches. The boys that wiggled "Goodbye" to us believed they had seen us for the last time, but wished they were with us just the same. Straight for a certain selected spot on the Belgian coast we laid our course, and when night fell we couldn't even see our own boats. There wasn't so much as a pin point of light showing on any of the craft. Every one wore dark uniforms, and every one in a while when we'd crowd on a little more speed there would suddenly loom up right ahead the dark hull of the boat we were following and we'd almost be aboard her.

The men at the wheels had to have their nerve with them.

Over the Mine Fields.
The chap who had proposed the raid—we might as well call him Jones, which is not his name—had figured out the conditions to a nicety, and on this particular night we were having the fullest high water of the autumn.

Just before we ran into the mine fields we passed a British monitor, about which I will have more to say later, and then began the real work of the expedition.

As every one knows, some mines are set so that they rise and fall with the tide and remain always a certain distance below the surface of the water, and if we didn't hit one of these it would be merely a matter of luck. There were thousands of mines all around us, and there was no earthly way of telling where any of them were.

As for the mines which are anchored always the same distance above the bottom of the sea, we were counting on the extra high tide to take us over these. At least Jones had figured that it would.

There is no moon. We dash along full speed ahead, for we must run in, accomplish our task and run out again before that tide ebb enough to make it next to impossible for even our light draft craft to escape because of the anchored mines coming to the surface.

The men in each crew have been carefully selected. They are all in the best physical condition, good swimmers, and the Brass Hat (officers) have even made certain that none of them has a cold. A sneeze or a cough might betray us. Despite this, the damp, chilly night air makes one of the men in our boat sneeze suddenly. It sounds to us like the crash of a mine. I don't see why it didn't take the top of the fellow's head off. Our finely made motors, of course, were muffled until you could not distinguish their purr ten feet away.

"A thousand yards or so and we'll be across the fields," says the Brass Hat in our boat. He has it figured down pretty fine. Now we are skimming over a bar, where a heavier boat could not go.

Discover Enemy Destroyers.

We strain our eyes ahead to catch the white gleam of the water of our leading craft and stare behind to make out the white bow wave of the one following us. It is the only way we can keep ourselves in line.

Presently I pick up out of the blackness of the night a patch of something that is even blacker. A ripple runs down my spine. The great moment has arrived. This is not like chasing a submarine which is trying to hide and which you can almost run circles around. It is more like six mosquitoes tackling a band of giants. If ever they can hit us a slap we will be crushed to jelly.

I point out the black patch to the Brass Hat. He strains through his night glasses, then hands them to me. "Destroyer!" he says.

The term is well applied, and I realize for the first time what destructive power one of these sleek sea fighters has. She is running without lights. We wonder in whispers whether the other craft have sighted her. There is no way for us to signal them. The man standing at the wheel throws her over a little to starboard, following the white wake of the boat ahead of us.

"They see her," says the Brass Hat next. "They're circling in."

A glance astern shows us that our followers have observed the change in our course. I do not know how far we are from that destroyer. In the dark she looms so big that it seems we must be going to graze her.

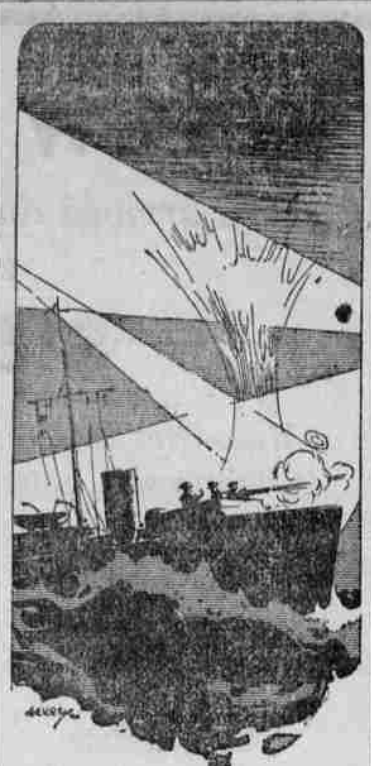
There is a lurid flash of red in the darkness ahead—a deafening roar—the smell of battle is in our nostrils. The leader's three incher has barked. Ours barks at almost the same time. Ours has bitten, for we can see the flash of the explosion as the shell falls on board the destroyer. That is better luck than we had looked for.

The Searchlights Scour the Sea.

The flashes have shown us other craft—destroyers, patrol boats and gunboats. No hope of concealment now. We wait just long enough between shots to make it hard for the Germans to locate us from the flash of the guns. Our engines, with the mufflers open to give us all possible speed, are roaring almost as loudly as the cannon it seems.

The Boches must be confused. They haven't fired on us yet. Searchlights are darting everywhere across the water and in the sky. Their one object is to find and destroy us, but they cannot figure out what to look for. They of course think we have come in through the channel, and their powerful rays sweep the entrance to the harbor and the waters just inside, while others play over the surface from whence we fired our first shots. They don't expect craft of our size to attempt such a daring raid.

How much damage we have done we do not know, but we cease firing.



The Gunner Fires into the Source of the Light.

and double back, waiting until we are out of the zone from which we started to fight.

I do not suppose any of the Huns ever thought of the little motor launches. They seem jumpy in their nerves, judging by the way they handle the searchlights. Probably they think some new engine of warfare is attacking them, like the tanks which so surprised them in the trenches one fine day.

Umph! Suddenly I am blinded. I think for a hundredth of a second that I am shot, and my head is splitting. It is a searchlight, the rays fall and square in my eyes. The gunner fires into the source of the light. It seems to be coming from a gunboat. If he hits her he will be lucky, for it is impossible for us to see anything.

We can hear the "woomp-woomp" of shells dropping into the water around us. We have made up our minds that it is all over, but two of the other boats, not being blinded by the searchlights, turn their fire on our tormentor. If the Germans hold on to us we are gone, but they seem to be in a frenzy, and while they sweep round, trying to pick up the other craft, we change our course, and they do not seem able to find us again. They fire on every stick of driftage and spar that darkens the surface of the illuminated water.

Out Over the Dangers of the Mines.

When the rising sun began to streak the sky we were safe. Way off to port lay the monitor we had passed the night before, and the Brass Hat, in command of the expedition, signaled us to run over to her and take account.

The monitor was one of a type much in evidence during the first years of the war, mounting heavy guns forward in an armored turret. The guns were made in America, and most of the monitors were named after American generals.

They were used on work that took them constantly into the mine fields, and for that reason they must have special protection against mines and torpedoes. Just how this is accomplished I do not feel at liberty to tell, but because of it an amusing incident occurred. The first motor launch was running at rather low speed in toward the monitor, so as to come alongside. All of a sudden we saw her sort of climb out of the water, bow first, heel over and lie there as though she had run up on a bar.

A couple of "matloes" (sailors) on the deck of the monitor began swearing at the crew, and every man in the M. L. was thrown off his feet by the shock which stopped the boat. The swearing was not confined to the monitor's men. The M. L. had run high and dry on to the shore which forms a part of the more or less intricate protection against torpedoes and mines that modern monitors carry. They had to use a crane to get her off.

Well, we had roll call and found only one man slightly hurt. A bit of shell had struck him in the shoulder. A piece the size of a man's palm was imbedded in the side of one of the M. L.'s. We had got off mighty lucky. I might say here that later six other boats made the experiment again, and only one got lost to England, so it isn't such a soft assignment. In that single craft were all the men from the five launches who had survived the hell they ran into. And there was plenty of room, for those who had been lost were many.

Under orders the survivors of that raid refrained from telling what actually happened, but in general it is true that the Germans must have realized what occurred on the first expedition, and they were ready. The element of surprise, which saved us all from going to kingdom come, was absent.

The officer in command of the one which was not destroyed cruised around in the glare of the searchlights until he had gathered in every living thing that still struggled in the water—a man's job in that searching glare of light and hail of shells.

(Continued next week)

Safe Remedy for Children

Every parent is, or should be, careful in giving medicine to children. Chas. Baker, Brownsville, Tex., writes: "For some years past I have used Foley's Honey and Tar and have found it especially efficient for bad coughs of my children. I always recommend it to my friends as a safe remedy for children, as it contains no opiates. My wife would not think of using any other kind of cough medicine as it is certain to bring quick and lasting relief." It checks croup.—Jones Drug Co.

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M'NARY DIFFERS WITH CHAPMAN'S JUDGMENT

The newspapers of the state are practically a unit in their objection to publishing Liberty loan advertising free of cost to the government. Taking the stand that advertising space is their only salable commodity and their only means of livelihood, the newspapermen believe that the government is asking of them a thing that is manifestly unjust and unfair.

No more right is it to ask the steel trust to furnish armor plate for warships without charge—and the government is paying them more than \$50 a ton for such steel—than it is to ask the newspapers to float a bond issue through free advertising. The farmer is not asked to give his crops to the government, yet the newspaper is asked to give its crop—which is advertising space.

C. C. Chapman, publisher of the Oregon Voter, is leading in a very small opposition to the stand of the newspapers. Mr. Chapman, in a self-designed attempt to see to it that the newspapers derive nothing from Liberty loan advertising addressed a telegram to Senator Charles L. McNary at Washington. That Mr. McNary sees the justice of the newspaperman's demands is evident from his reply to Mr. Chapman. The senator says:

"Your telegram, protesting against the payment by the government for newspaper advertising in the exploitation of the contemplated second liberty loan bond, reached me yesterday. I observe your generous intention of serving your nation in this project without compensation. Truly this course upon your part is both commendable and patriotic, but it does not, in my judgment, conflict with the underlying principle that the government should deal alike with all who render it a commercial service.

"As a successful publisher you know that advertising space is a commodity bearing the same relation to the newspaper owner as ore bears to the steel magnate. Do we hear voices suggesting that these affluent operators render their wares without charges to the government? Indeed no.

"Then why should the press—particularly the rural press that reaches the masses—be expected to render a gratuitous service when we must know that aside from their legitimate charge they will, as they have, render the nation a patriotic service editorially and reportorially?

"If the government standard of dealing with commodities must be erected on the foundation of patriotism, then in fairness this appeal should be made without distinction to the activities involved.

"Entertaining the belief that your protest fails to reckon with the factors I have recounted, yet commending your liberal spirit, I feel impelled to differ with your judgment."

NEWSPAPER WRITING

For Pleasure or Profit Writers Do Better by Observing Rules

Clearly there is a kind of writing which pertains to the newspaper as distinct from the novel, the sermon, the oration. Seldom does a daily or weekly publish a sermon or an oration, and there is ample reason. Such composition would not be read. The paper would be checked at the receiving end—the exchequer.

The newspapers are presented with the problem of developing a style of writing peculiar to themselves. They must reach a folk who are busy and who often are fatigued—the laborer on the street car hurrying to his work, the commuter rushing from suburb to city, the business man at the breakfast table with his mind on the stock market or the crop conditions, the busy housewife and, with the coming of rural delivery, the farmer.

The reader of the newspaper must have the news quickly and interestingly told. To make his paper appeal to the interests of all these groups is the purpose that effects all the work of the newspaper—the selection of the news, its arrangement, the size of the type, the color and the spacing and, certainly not less, the style of composition. Thus the newspapers are developing a science in journalism. Into this science must enter a certain technique of writing differing widely from that of any other sort of writing.

First, the meat in the cocoon must be on the shell; the heart of the matter must grow on the rind. The story must be in the first paragraph—nay, the first sentence if possible. All nonessentials must be rigidly amputated. The climax must come first. This arrangement is psychological, for the newspaper must arouse interest, and it may not seek to interest long.

The organization of the newspaper story is, from the standpoint of all the writings of the past, revolutionary. It is the exact opposite to the arrangement of a novel or drama, in which interest rises, waxes, reaches crisis and climax until the reader gasps and chokes. The psychology of the newspaper demands that the reader begin by gasping.

The country newspaper has the special task of cultivating neighborhood spirit, ideals, friendliness. This calls for a style peculiar to the country press.

In the matter of language it is customary to assume that the country newspaper is a lout. Endless fun is made of the society column with its accounts of weddings, parties, funerals and the comings and goings of the neighborhood. For me, I do not share the feeling of disdain. The most interesting matter in the world is human nature, and what the mayor of Wayne is doing is often just as interesting as what the German kaiser is doing and certainly much more popular in Wayne.

Many pages are written each week concerning insignificant happenings, and it is right that this should be. The increasing volume of such news

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"THE STORE THAT UNDERSELLS BECAUSE IT SELLS FOR CASH"

Every Woman Should Attend Our Great Exposition of Correct Fall Modes —Garments Attractively Priced—

Marvelously complete is this authoritative showing of the best and most practical in women's wear. It emphasizes, as nothing else can, the alertness and initiative which this store is capable of exercising despite the disturbed market conditions and obstacles that have confronted our buyers. It is a great exposition of duly authorized modes for Fall and Winter—a collection particularly rich in smart and clever adaptations in

Handsome Tailored Suits at \$17.45 to \$45
Fashionable Fall Coats at \$8.50 to \$60
Nobby One-Piece Dresses at \$6.95 to \$40

Included are all desirable new and staple colors in plain shades and novelties—finely tailored garments in materials to suit every taste and purpose. You are cordially invited to come and compare values.

compels special forms of treatment. The wording of such notices has a great sameness, but there is little if any objection to this, for in the main people read only those in which they are particularly interested.

Slang may enrich the language and often does. What can be more compelling than the phrase "Don't monkey with the buzzaw?" Newspapers are full of such enlivening expressions. No blanket condemnation of slang is possible. Still, not always is it good. "Where do you stop at?" asked the inquiring stranger of the Boston policeman. "Just before 'at,'" was the biting response. No slang should be used unless it really conveys the meaning better than other forms. Today a large part of the vocabulary of the average high school and university student is covered by the word "dope," cheap, lazy, vulgar slang from the sporting column of the newspaper. If we are to have slang let it be meaningful, let it enrich our speech.—American Press.

Prolific Berkshires

We have a choice lot of June farrow sows and gilts for sale. We have pigs from three different sires, including Driver Baron Duke No. 201084, champion and grand champion at the Northwest Stock Show, Portland, Dec., 1916. All stock registered in purchaser's name. If you are looking for good hogs for breeding purposes you will find them at Hood View farm, O. C., Rt. 3, Bx. 72. HARRIS & SONS.

May Play With M. A. A. C.

"Jake" Risley, son of Mr. and Mrs. John Risley of this county who made an all-star berth for himself last year as the crack center of the University of Oregon football eleven, will probably play with the famous Multnomah club eleven this year. Risley is one of the best centers Oregon has had in several years and his addition to the crack Portland team is looked forward to with pleasure by the clubmen.

Soldiers Certified

The local examining board for the national army, yesterday certified for service Herbert W. Holmes and Gus Rudolph Hallman, the former of Milwaukie and the latter of Boring. The examinations in these cases were postponed because both men were confined by injuries when the remainder of the quota was called for examination. Hallman will file an exemption claim with the board setting out the fact that he

is not a citizen of the United States, where he has lived three years, but a citizen of Sweden.

and Raphael Drake was signed here Friday by Judge J. U. Campbell. To Mrs. Drake was restored her former name, Ethel Norris.

One Divorce Granted
A divorce decree separating Ethel

Courier and Daily Journal—\$4.75.

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